PEOPLE & CULTURE · TALEEMABAD

We used to stay *silent.*

Then we decided that wasn't good enough.

A story about two values that changed how we hire

THE BEFORE

Like most companies, we *didn't respond.*

When a candidate's profile wasn't the right fit, we moved on. No feedback. No closure.

Just silence.

We knew it wasn't ideal. But saying nothing felt "safe." Saying something — honestly — felt risky.

THE OLD WAY

"We regret to inform you..." — or nothing at all.

THE REALISATION

Candidates put real effort into applying. They deserved better.

VALUE 01 · COURAGEOUS CONVERSATIONS

We decided to say the *hard thing.*

The risk we took

Telling a candidate their CV had gaps could **easily go wrong.** They could feel judged, push back, or leave with a worse impression of us.

What we chose instead

We named the gap **directly and honestly.** We acknowledged what was strong. We gave real direction — not platitudes.

The harder truth

A courageous conversation isn't just **saying the hard thing.** It's saying it in a way the other person can actually receive.

Why it mattered

Because **every candidate put real effort** into applying. Silence was not a kindness. It was avoidance.

VALUE 02 · CONTINUOUSLY IMPROVE

We got better at how we *communicate.*

This wasn't just about being kind.

It was about **raising the standard** of how we talk to people — even when the answer is no.

We treated each email as a craft. Something worth writing well.

01 **Read the CV first**
Not skimmed — actually read. Before writing a single word.

02 **Name what was strong**
Every profile had something worth acknowledging. We found it.

03 **Name the gap — clearly**
Specific, honest, and without corporate softening.

04 **Give real direction**
What they could do next. Not a consolation — actionable guidance.

IT COULD HAVE GONE BADLY. IT DIDN'T.

What candidates wrote back.

Unsolicited replies — they wrote to say thank you, not to negotiate.

> *I'll be honest, receiving a rejection is never easy, but the way you delivered this one made all the difference. Thank you for seeing me as more than just an application.*
>
> CANDIDATE · FIELD COORDINATOR ROLE

> *This is one of the best rejections I have ever received. This is one of the reasons which always encourages me to be part of Taleemabad.*
>
> CANDIDATE · FIELD COORDINATOR ROLE

> *It is genuinely rare to receive a response this considered. It speaks well of Taleemabad's culture that you give applicants honest, constructive guidance rather than a standard reply.*
>
> CANDIDATE · FIELD COORDINATOR ROLE

COURAGEOUS CONVERSATIONS

CONTINUOUSLY IMPROVE

This is what our *values* look like in practice.

Not on a wall. Not in a handbook.

In how we show up — even when the answer is no.

💬 SAY THE HARD THING

✍️ WRITE IT WELL

🤲 LEAVE THEM BETTER